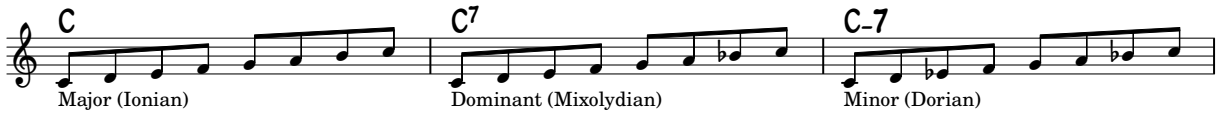
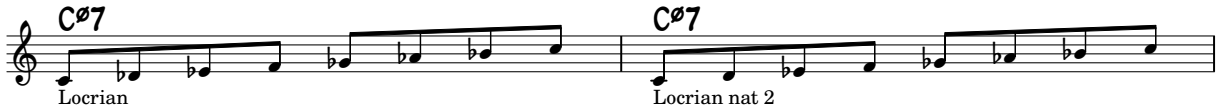
# 1 Common scales for major, dominant and minor chords




# 2 Scales for half diminished chords

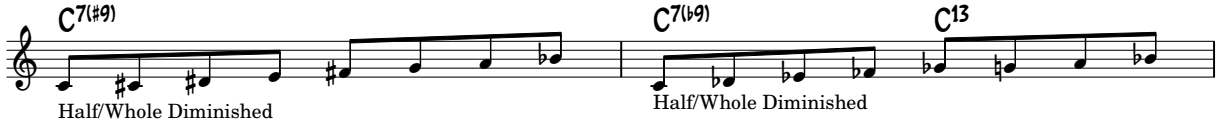
## 2.1 Locrian

Play the scale 1/2 step higher (D♭) starting on the 7th (C)

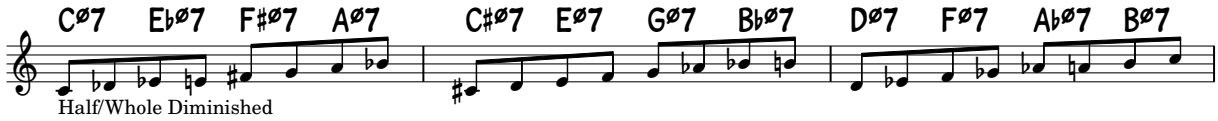



## 2.2 Two ways of looking at the half/whole (H/W) diminished scale.

It contains the chord tones for a half diminished chord. (♭3, ♭5, ♭7)
It can work for chords like C7(♯9), C7(♭9), C7(13♭9) = C7(13) = (C7♯5)

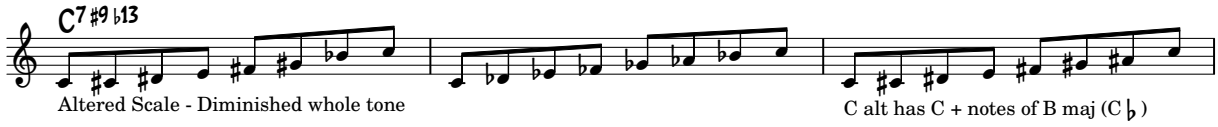



This is the same scale starting on any of the 4 notes C, E♭, F♯, or A.
There are only 3 distinct H/W scales.

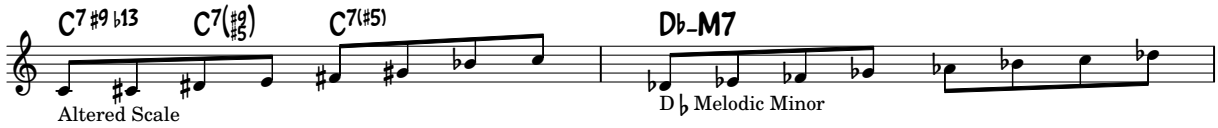



## 2.3 Altered Scale

Three ways of looking at the altered scale.
It is very similar to the half/whole diminished.
You can also look at it as having the notes of the scale a 1/2 step lower.

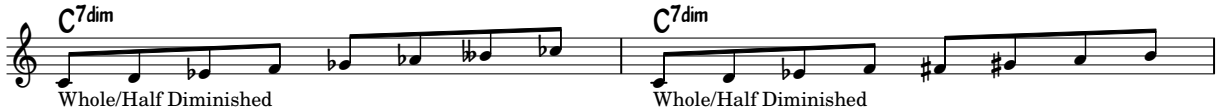



Another way of thinking of it is as the notes of the melodic minor (♭3) starting 1/2 step up.

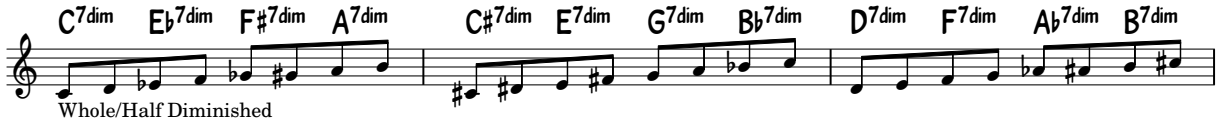


# 3 Diminished chords (W/H Dim)

Two ways of looking at the whole/half diminished.
You can think of this as a diminished chord (C, E♭, G♭, B♭♭) plus a whole step above each chord tone (D, F, A♭, C♭).

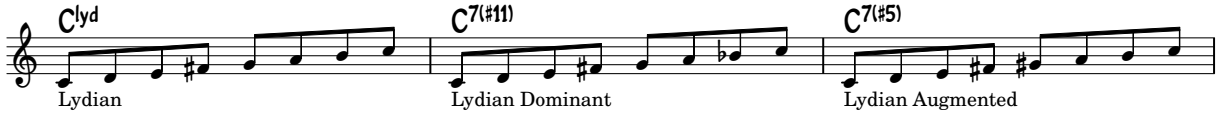



There are only 3 distinct W/H scales.



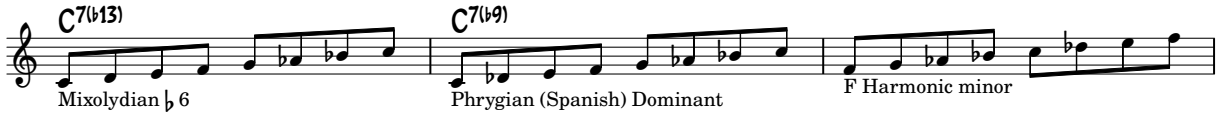

# 4 Lydian Chords

The Lydian scale has a raised 4th (11th). (4th mode of major scale)
Dominant indicates a lowered 7th.
Augmented indicates a raised 5th.



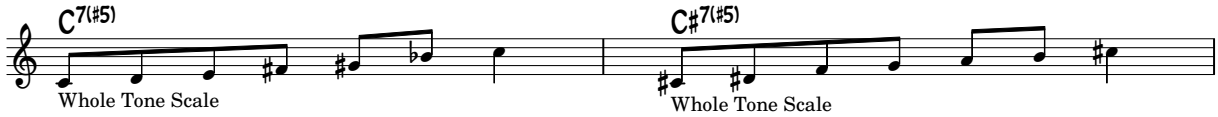

# 5 Phrygian (Spanish) Dominant

The Phrygian (Spanish) dominant scale is the 5th mode of the Harmonic minor scale (♭3, ♭6).
It has an exotic sound.



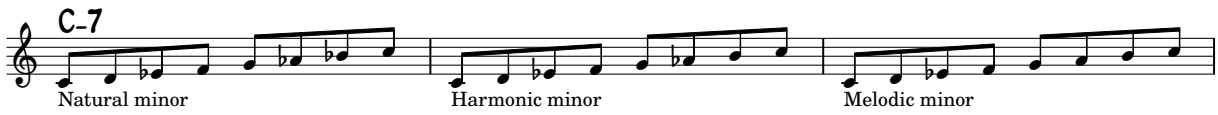

# 6 Whole tone

There are only 2 whole tone scales. (Both given below.)



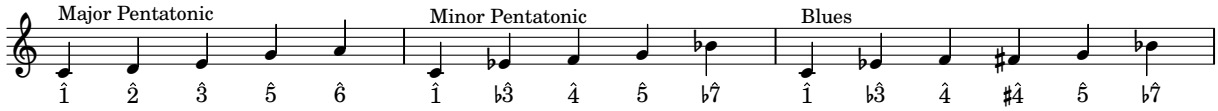
# 7 Minor Scales

Natural Minor: Add 3 ♭'s (♭3, ♭6, ♭7)
Harmonic Minor: ♭3 & ♭6 (natural minor with raised [natural] 7)
Melodic minor: ♭3 - Classical music has melodic minor rising, and natural descending.




# 8 Pentatonic and Blues

The minor pentatonic has the same notes as the major pentatonic of the relative minor.
C minor pentatonic has same notes as the E♭major pentatonic.
The blues scale is like the minor pentatonic with an added "blues" tone (♯4)




# 9 Chord Choices

| Chord | Basic | | | More altered |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| Cmaj7 | Ionian | Lydian | Lydian ♯5 | |
| Cmin7 | Dorian | Aeolian | Phrygian | |
| C7 | Mixolydian | Lydian ♭7 | ♭9 diminished | altered |
| C half-dim (min7 ♭5) | Locrian | Locrian nat9 | | |
| C7dim | W/H dim | | | |
| C-Maj7 | Melodic minor | | | |
| CMaj7 ♯5 | Lydian ♯5 | | | |
| C7 ♯11 | Lydian ♭7 | | | |
| C7 ♭9 | Phrygian Dominant | Altered | | |
| C7 ♯9 | Diminished-dominant (H/W dim) | | | |
| C7 ♯8 ♭13 | Altered | | | |
| altered dom | Altered | | | |

# 10 Modes of scales

| Mode | Major | Melodic Minor |
|---|---|---|
| **1** | Ionian<br>Major | Minor<br>♭3<br>Use over minMaj7 |
| **2** | Dorian<br>Minor<br>♭3, ♭7 | Dorian ♭2<br>Minor<br>♭2, ♭3, ♭7 |
| **3** | Phrygian<br>Darker minor<br>Add 4 ♭'s<br><br>Not the same as Phrygian dom | Lydian ♯5<br>Major<br>♯4, ♯5<br>Use over Maj7 ♯5 |
| **4** | Lydian<br>Major<br>Add 1 ♯<br><br>Not the same as Phrygian dom | Lydian ♭7<br>Major<br>♯4, ♭7<br>Use over dom ♯11 |
| **5** | Mixolydian<br>Major<br>Add 1 ♭<br>Use over dom 7 | Mixolydian ♭6<br>Major<br>♭6, ♭7 |
| **6** | Aeolian<br>Natural minor<br>♭3, ♭6, ♭7<br>Add 3 ♭'s | Locrian nat9<br><br>lower 5th, raise 9th<br><br>Use over half-dim (min7 ♭5) |
| **7** | Locrian<br>Half-diminished<br>♭2, ♭3, ♭5, ♭6,<br>Add 5 ♭'s<br>Use over half-dim (min7 ♭5)<br><br>Key of scale 1/2 step higher than root | Altered<br><br>Use over altered dom<br>Use over dom7 ♭9<br>Use over dom7 ♯9 ♭13 |

Table 1: Modes of Scales